ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 67

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Oromo Alphabet

Qubee Afaan Oromoo

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 31 Oromo Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b C c

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Oromo Alphabet — Qubee Afaan Oromoo
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 67

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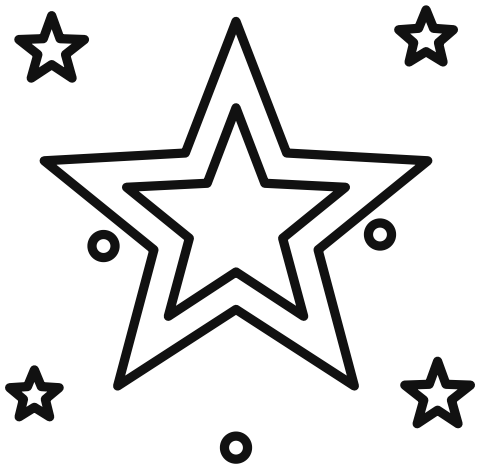
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



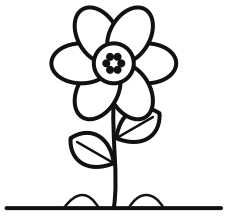
This book belongs to

Kitaabni kun kan

I started learning Oromo on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 67 is Oromo. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **ch' k' t' p'** with an apostrophe are **popped** sounds (ejectives): close your throat, then let the sound burst out.
- **'** between vowels is the *hudhaa*: a tiny catch in the voice, like the middle of "uh-oh".
- **dh** is a 'd' swallowed inwards; **r** is rolled.
- In Oromo spelling a doubled vowel is long (**aa ee ii oo uu**). In the pronunciation, **aa** is a long 'a' as in "father", **ee** says 'ee' as in "see", **oo** says 'oo' as in "moon", **oh** says 'o' as in "go" and **eh** says 'e' as in "bed".
- Oromo uses pitch rather than strong stress, so no syllable is written in capitals here.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Oromo name** written in Oromo (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Oromo letter name · Qubee* shows the name Oromo children use for the letter (B is «ba», C is «ca»...) and its row of syllables, the way Oromo children learn to read.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard written Oromo (Qubee).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Oromo! Afaan Oromoo

a-faan o-roh-moh — the Oromo word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **37 million people** speak Afaan Oromoo — one of the most spoken languages of Africa.[3]

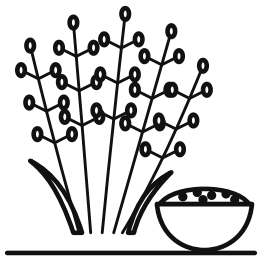
Where?
Mostly in **Ethiopia**, in the highlands and lowlands around Addis Ababa, Adama, Jimma and Harar, and also in northern **Kenya**.

How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, called **Qubee**, from **left to right**.

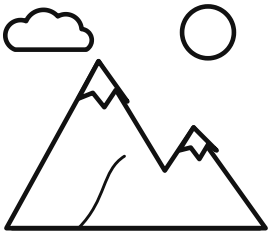
How many letters?
26 single letters and **5 double letters** (CH DH NY PH SH): **31** in this book.

Popping sounds!
C, Q, X and **PH** are popped sounds. Try *qamadii* (wheat) and *xaafii* (teff)!

Did you know?
Ethiopia is the home of **coffee**. In Afaan Oromoo coffee is *buna*, and families share it with friends and neighbours.







The Oromo Alphabet Qubee

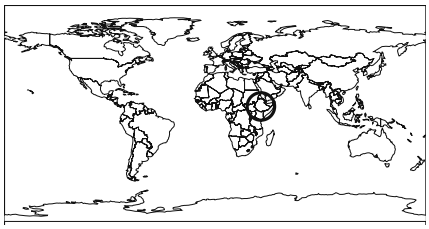
26 single letters – Qubee

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Cc** *ch'ah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*	**Gg** *gah*
Hh *hah*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*	**Nn** *nah*
Oo *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Qq** *k'ah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*	**Tt** *tah*	**Uu** *oo*
Vv *vah*	**Ww** *wah*	**Xx** *t'ah*	**Yy** *yah*	**Zz** *zah*		

5 double letters – Qubee dachaa

Ch ch *chah*	**Dh dh** *dhah*	**Ny ny** *nyah*	**Ph ph** *p'ah*	**Sh sh** *shah*

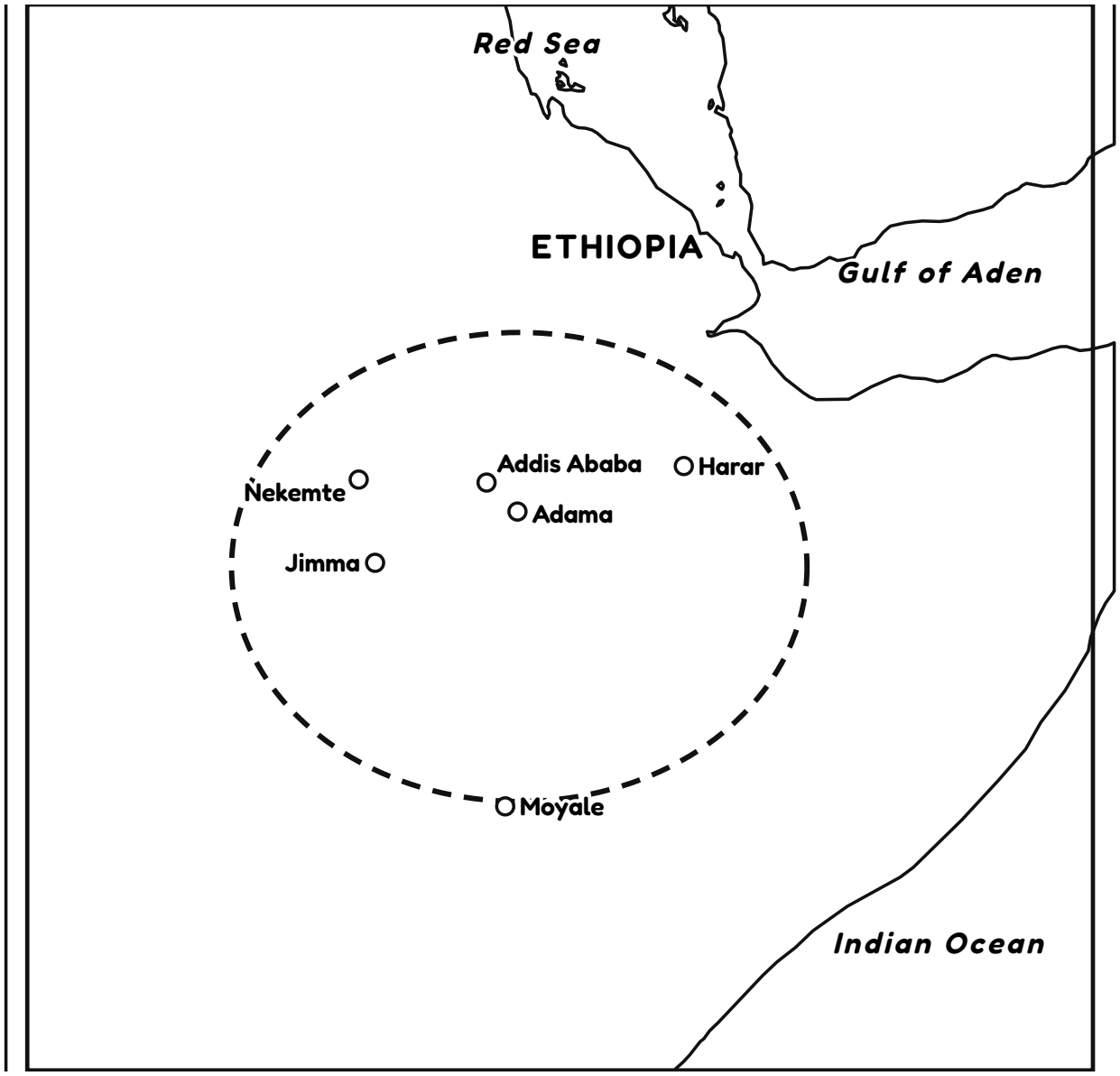
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Horn of Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Oromo spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the seas **blue**. **Find it:** the dashed line shows where most Oromo speakers live, around Addis Ababa, Adama, Jimma, Nekemte and Harar, down to Moyale in the south.

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QUBEE

The Letters Qubee

koo-beh — the Oromo alphabet

Afaan Oromoo is written in **Qubee** (say *koo-beh*): the **26 letters** you know from English, plus **5 double letters** that come at the end of this book.

Popping sounds
C, **Q**, **X** and **PH** are **ejectives**: close your throat, then let the sound pop out. In Oromo, **C** is a popped ‘ch’, **Q** a popped ‘k’ and **X** a popped ‘t’ — never ‘ks’!

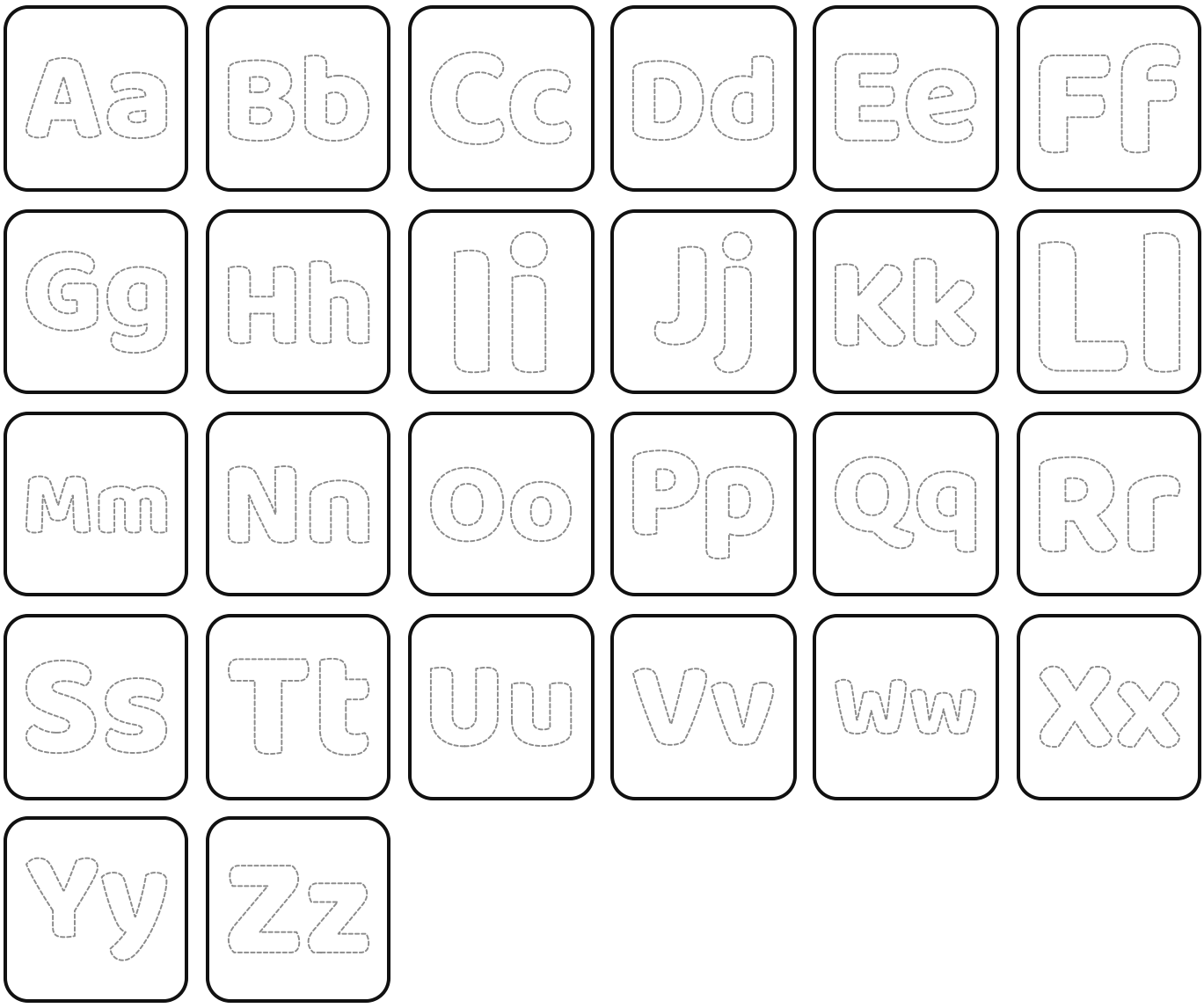
Write it twice
A doubled vowel is long (*a*, *aa*) and a doubled consonant is held longer (*t*, *tt*). Doubling can change the meaning, so listen carefully!

The little catch: hudhaa
The mark **’** is called *hudhaa*. It is a tiny stop in the voice, as in *ji’a* (moon).

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the single letters Qubee

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · MAQAA

a

ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

A a — «a»

a · aa — ba · baa

Write it twice for a long sound: **aa**.



AA **IS FOR**

aannan

aan-nan

milk

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · MAQAA

ba

bah

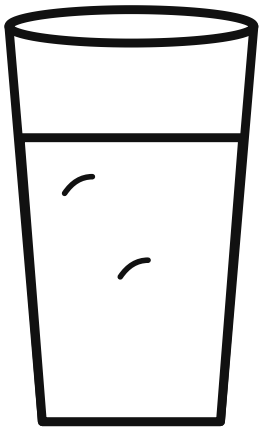
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu



BB IS FOR

bishaan

bi-shaan

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Cc

NAME · MAQAA

ca

ch'ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

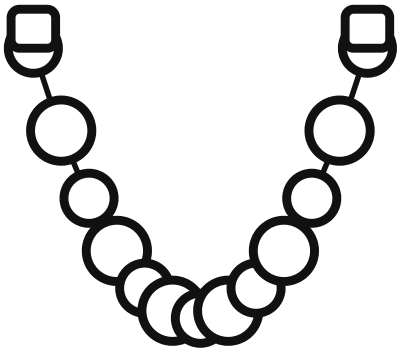
a popped ‘ch’ (ch’)

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

C c — «ca»

ca · ce · ci · co · cu

A **popped** sound: close your throat, then let the sound burst out.



CC IS FOR

callee

ch'al-leh

beads

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Cc Cc Cc Cc

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Dd

NAME · MAQAA

da

dah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “dog”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do · du



DD IS FOR

daabboo

daab-boh

bread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · MAQAA

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

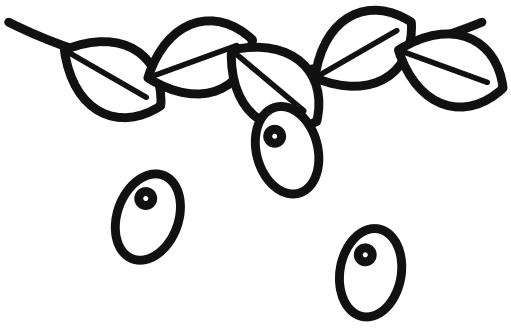
‘e’ as in “bed”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

E e — «e»

e · ee — be · bee

Write it twice for a long sound: **ee**.



EE IS FOR

ejersa

eh-jer-sa

wild olive tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · MAQAA

fa

fah

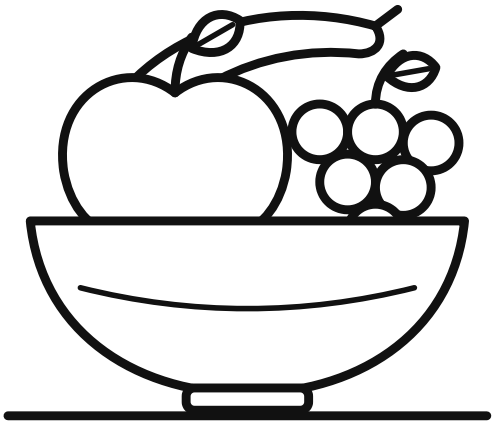
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

firii

fi-ree

fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · MAQAA

ga

gah

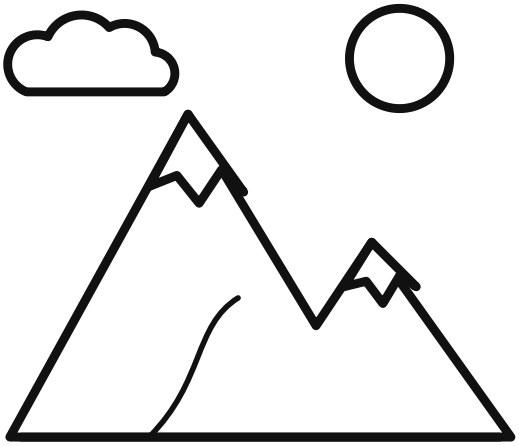
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



GG IS FOR

gaara

gaa-ra

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Hh

NAME · MAQAA

ha

hah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

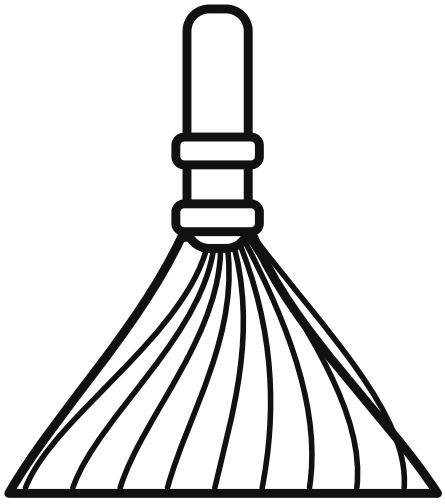
‘h’ as in “hat”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

H h — «ha»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu

The mark ’ (*hudhaa*) is a tiny catch in the voice.



HH IS FOR

haxaa'oo

ha-t'aa-'oh

broom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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Ii

NAME · MAQAA

i

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

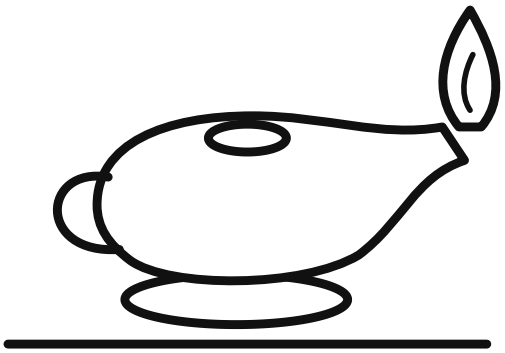
‘i’ as in “sit”; long **ii** as in “see”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

I i — «i»

i · ii — bi · bii

Write it twice for a long sound: **ii**.



II IS FOR

ibsaa

ib-saa

lamp · light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

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Jj

NAME · MAQAA

ja

jah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

J j — «ja»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju



JJ IS FOR

ji'a

ji-'a

moon · month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · MAQAA

ka

kah

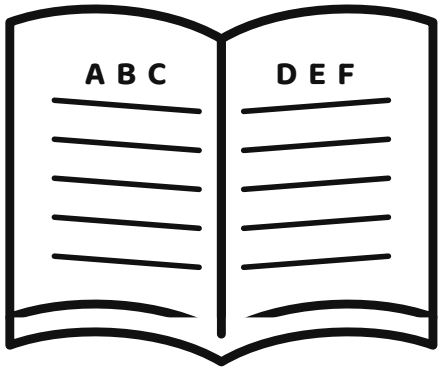
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku



KK IS FOR

kitaaba

ki-taa-ba

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Ll

NAME · MAQAA

la

lah

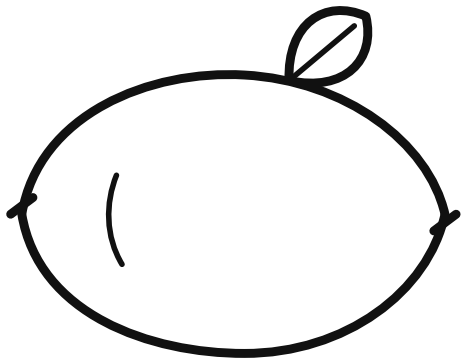
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo · lu



LL IS FOR

loomii

loh-mee

lemon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · MAQAA

ma

mah

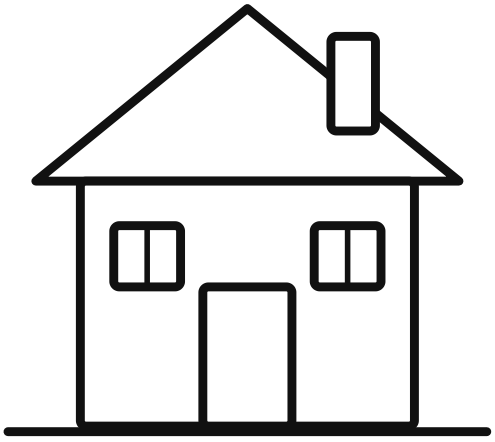
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu



MM IS FOR

mana

ma-na

house · home

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · MAQAA

na

nah

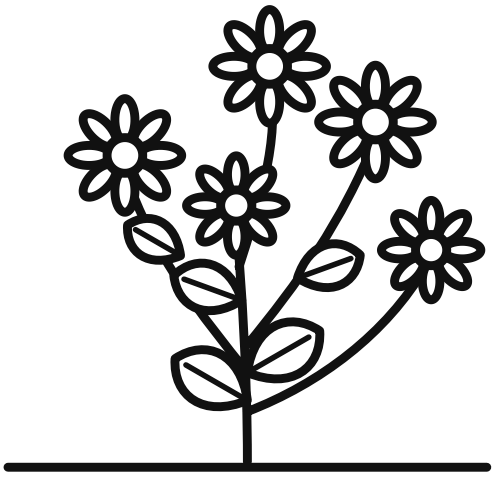
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



NN IS FOR

nuugii

noo-gee

niger-seed plant (noug)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · MAQAA

o

oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

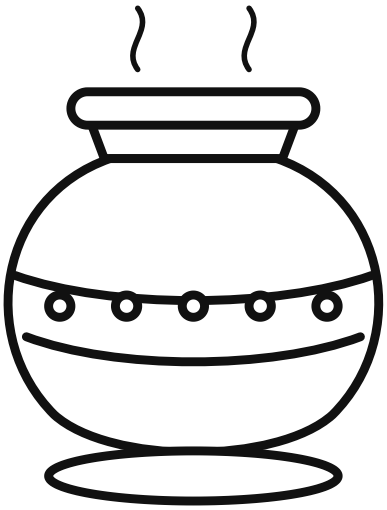
‘o’ as in “for” (short and pure)

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

O o — «o»

o · oo — bo · boo

Write it twice for a long sound: **oo**.



OO IS FOR

okkotee

ok-ko-teh

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · MAQAA

pa

pah

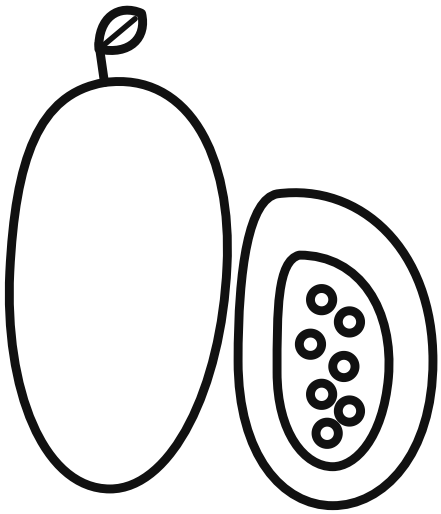
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen” — found only in words borrowed from other languages

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu



PP IS FOR

paappayyaa

paap-pay-yaa

papaya

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Qq

NAME · MAQAA

qa

k'ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

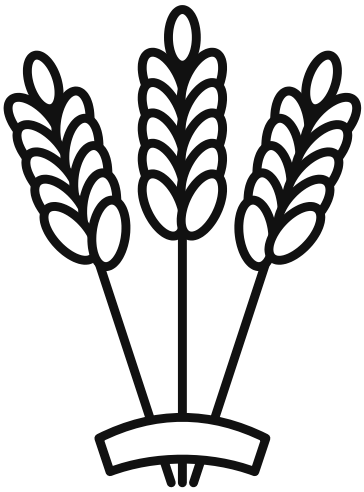
a popped ‘k’ (k’)

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Q q — «qa»

qa · qe · qi · qo · qu

A **popped** sound: close your throat, then let the sound burst out.



QQ IS FOR

qamadii

k'a-ma-dee

wheat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Qq Qq Qq Qq

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Rr

NAME · MAQAA

ra

rah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a rolled ‘r’

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru



RR **IS FOR**

rooba

roh-ba

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss

NAME · MAQAA

sa

sah

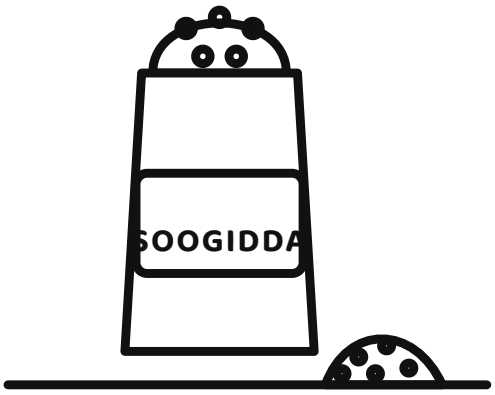
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so · su



SS IS FOR

soogidda

soh-gid-da

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · MAQAA

ta

tah

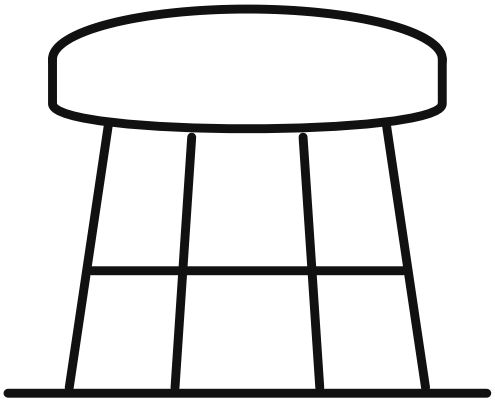
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “tap”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to · tu



TT IS FOR

teessoo

tehs-soh

seat · stool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · MAQAA

u

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

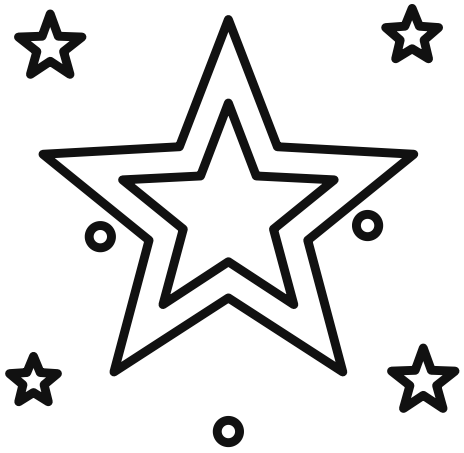
‘u’ as in “put”; long **uu** as in “moon”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

U u — «u»

u · uu — bu · buu

Write it twice for a long sound: **uu**.



UU IS FOR

urjii

ur-jee

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Vv

NAME · MAQAA

va

vah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

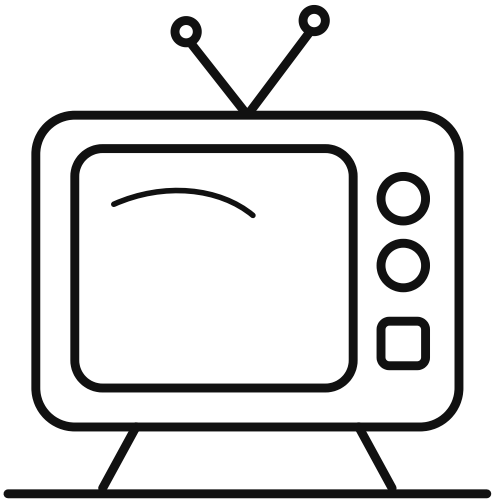
‘v’ as in “van” — found only in words borrowed from other languages

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

V v — «va»

va · ve · vi · vo · vu

V is rare. Find it inside *televiziyoona*!



VV IS FOR

televiziyoona

te-le-vi-zi-yoh-na

television

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Ww

NAME · MAQAA

wa

wah

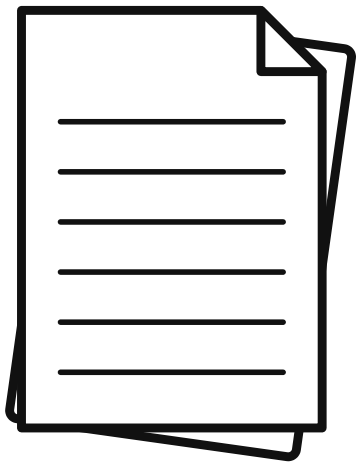
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

W w — «wa»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu



WW **IS FOR**

waraqaa

wa-ra-k'aa

paper

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Xx

NAME · MAQAA

xa

t'ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

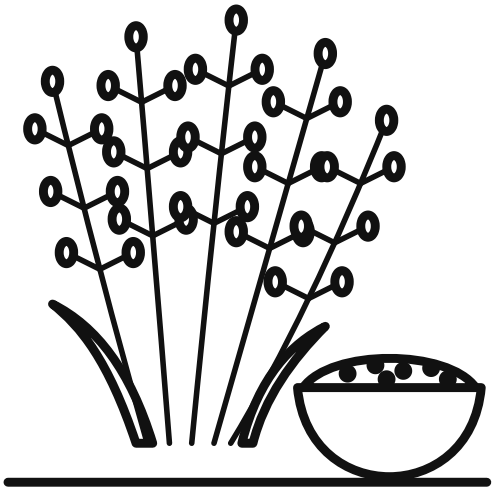
a popped ‘t’ (t’)

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

X x — «xa»

xa · xe · xi · xo · xu

X is **not** ‘ks’ in Afaan Oromoo! A **popped** sound: close your throat, then let the sound burst out.



XX IS FOR

xaafii

t'aa-fee

teff (a tiny grain)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Xx Xx Xx Xx

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Yy

NAME · MAQAA

ya

yah

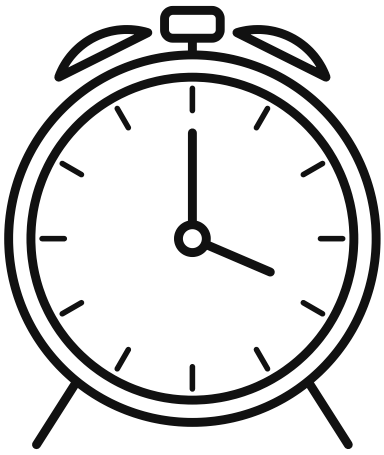
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Y y — «ya»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu



YY IS FOR

yeroo

ye-roh

time

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · MAQAA

za

zah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo” — found only in words borrowed from other languages

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Z z — «za»

za · ze · zi · zo · zu



ZZ IS FOR

zayitii

za-yi-tee

cooking oil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Zz Zz Zz Zz

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QUBEE DACHAA

The Double Letters Qubee dachaa

koo-beh da-chaa — “double letters”

Five sounds are written with **two letters**: **CH DH NY PH SH**. Each pair is **one sound**.

Soft and popped
CH is a soft ‘ch’ as in “chair”, but **C** alone is popped. **PH** is a popped ‘p’ — not ‘f’!

A few rare ones
Some books also teach **TS** (a popped ‘ts’) and **ZY** (the ‘s’ in “measure”). They are rare, so they are not on their own pages here.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the double letters Qubee dachaa

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Ch ch

NAME · MAQAA

cha

chah

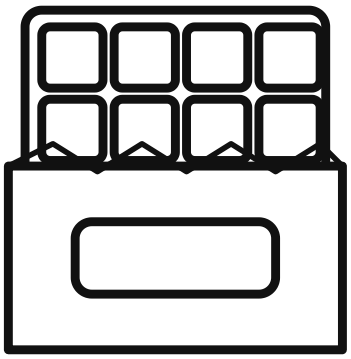
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair” (not popped) — mostly in borrowed words

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Ch ch — «cha»

cha · che · chi · cho · chu



CH CH IS FOR

chokolaatii

cho-ko-laa-tee

chocolate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch

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Dh dh

NAME · MAQAA

dha

dhah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

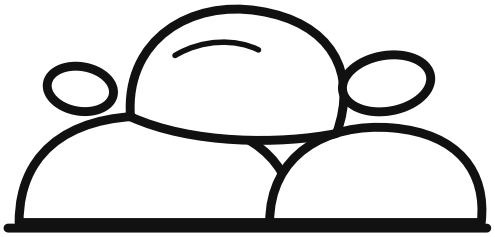
a ‘d’ swallowed inwards — the tongue touches the roof of the mouth

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Dh dh — «dha»

dha · dhe · dhi · dho · dhu

DH is one Oromo sound, not ‘d’ + ‘h’.



DH DH IS FOR

dhagaa

dha-gaa

stone

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Dh dh Dh dh Dh dh Dh dh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ny ny

NAME · MAQAA

nya

nyah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Ny ny — «nya»

nya · nye · nyi · nyo · nyu



NY NY IS FOR

nyaata

nyaa-ta

food

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

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Ph ph

NAME · MAQAA

pha

p'ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘p’ (p’)

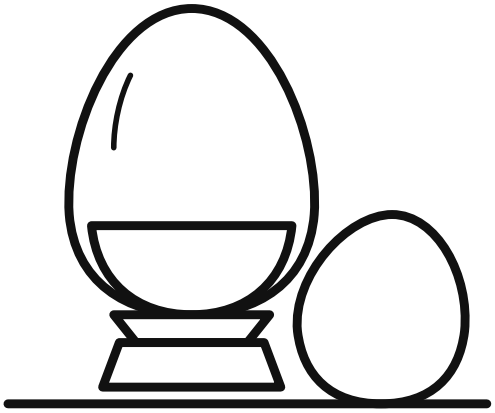
OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Ph ph — «pha»

pha · phe · phi · pho · phu

A **popped** sound: close your throat, then let the sound burst out.

PH hardly ever starts a word. Find it in the middle of *buphaa*!



PH PH IS FOR

buphaa

boo-p'aa

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

Ph ph Ph ph Ph ph Ph ph

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Sh sh

NAME · MAQAA

sha

shah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “ship”

OROMO LETTER NAME · QUBEE

Sh sh — «sha»

sha · she · shi · sho · shu



SH SH IS FOR

shaayii

shaa-yee

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · BARREESSI

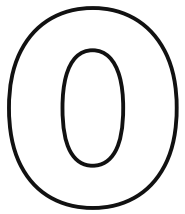
Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh

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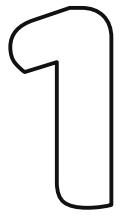
BONUS

Oromo numbers lakkoofsota *(lak-kohf-so-ta)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Oromo: *duw-waa, tok-ko, la-ma, sa-dee...*



0
duwwaa
duw-waa
zero



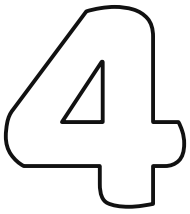
1
tokko
tok-ko
one



2
lama
la-ma
two



3
sadii
sa-dee
three



4
afur
a-foor
four



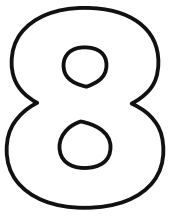
5
shan
shan
five



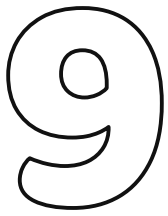
6
jaha
ja-ha
six



7
torba
tor-ba
seven



8
saddeet
sad-deht
eight



9
sagal
sa-gal
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Oromo words Jechoota jalqabaa

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalaamu alaykum

as-sa-laa-moo a-lay-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaykum assalaam

wa a-lay-koom as-sa-laam
And upon you be peace (the reply)

Akkam?

ak-kam
Hello, how are you?

Maqaan koo ... dha

ma-k'aan koh ... dha
My name is ...

Galatoomi

ga-la-toh-mee
Thank you

Jazaakallaahu khayran

ja-zaa-kal-laa-hoo khay-ran
May Allah reward you with good

haadha · abbaa

haa-dha · ab-baa
Mother · Father

obboleessa · obboleettii

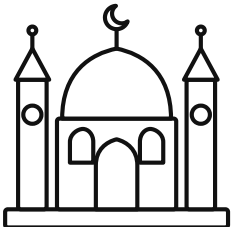
ob-bo-lehs-sa · ob-bo-leht-tee
Brother · Sister

eeyyee · lakki

ehy-yeh · lak-ki
Yes · No

Ani Afaan Oromoo barachaa jira!

a-ni a-faan o-roh-moh ba-ra-chaa ji-ra
I am learning Oromo!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

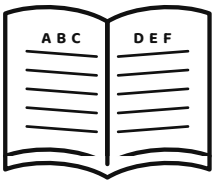
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

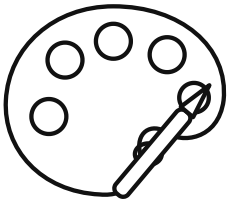
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International).

What's next?
You have met all **31 Oromo letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Oromo, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Maashaa Allaah! Baay'ee gaarii!

maa-shaa al-laah! baay-'eh gaa-ree — Mashallah! Well done, very good!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 31 letters of the Oromo alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.